

Kyle Heller

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SUMMARY

Platform engineer with over 7 years in enterprise cloud environments, specializing in Kubernetes, Terraform, and cloud-native infrastructure. Background in consulting on production multi-tenant infrastructure for service providers running BaaS/DRaaS at scale. Built internal automation tooling and self-service workflows using Python, API integrations, and workflow orchestration. Hands-on with Kubernetes cluster operations, Helm, ArgoCD, observability (Prometheus/Grafana), policy enforcement (OPA/Gatekeeper), and Kubernetes-native data protection (Veeam Kasten). Azure certified (Solutions Architect Expert, DevOps Engineer Expert), Certified Kubernetes Administrator, and HashiCorp Terraform Associate. M.S. Computer Science from CU Boulder.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: Azure (AKS, Virtual Networks, Storage, Entra ID, Key Vault), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Linux

Platform & Orchestration: Helm, Kustomize, ArgoCD, Gateway API, NetworkPolicy, Pod Security Standards, OPA/Gatekeeper, Veeam Kasten, namespace isolation, resource quotas

CI/CD & Automation: GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, ArgoCD, n8n, Power Automate

Development: Python, Bash, FastAPI, REST APIs, LLM API integration

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, SLO/SLI frameworks

Security & Governance: IAM/RBAC, OPA/Gatekeeper, Pod Security Admission, secrets management, default-deny network policies, least-privilege design

EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead, NA VCSP Support

Jul 2022 – Present

Veeam Software — Columbus, OH

- Primary escalation point for VCSP partners running production BaaS and DRaaS environments; led complex troubleshooting across compute, storage, networking, and application layers including Cloud Connect, VSPC, VBR, Veeam Kasten, and Enterprise Manager.
- Built end-to-end automation for compliance reporting using n8n, Python, Puppeteer, and Claude API integration, reducing a 2–3 hour manual workflow to ~15 minutes and eliminating data accuracy issues.
- Conducted technical assessments of partner environments, identifying configuration risks and recommending architectural improvements tied to security, business continuity, and cost optimization.
- Served as liaison between Support, R&D, and QA, delivering structured root cause analysis with reproducible evidence to accelerate product fixes and improve system reliability.
- Mentored and coached a team of 10 engineers on troubleshooting methodology, escalation handling, and knowledge management; established standardized playbooks and diagnostic workflows as KCS Knowledge Domain Expert.

Cloud Support Engineer

Jan 2019 – Jul 2022

Veeam Software — Columbus, OH

- Supported VCSP partners running production BaaS and DRaaS environments; diagnosed failures across backup jobs, replication, storage targets, and network connectivity to minimize downtime and data loss risk.
- Guided partners through solution design, migrations, and upgrades; provided hands-on assistance with Cloud Connect configuration, tenant onboarding, and VSPC deployment.
- Performed structured log analysis and environment reviews; translated complex technical findings into actionable recommendations for both technical and management stakeholders.

PROJECTS

Platform Starter Kit • Terraform + Kubernetes + Veeam Kasten + ArgoCD • github.com/kyle-heller/Platform-Starter-Kit

- Terraform modules provisioning AKS clusters with configurable node pools, networking, RBAC, and remote state on Azure Storage; separate dev/prod environment configurations. Kasten storage module provisions Azure Blob backend with managed identity RBAC for K10 exports.

- Veeam Kasten integration: K10 backup policy with daily snapshots, 7/4/3 GFS retention, and automated export to Azure Blob via managed identity; VolumeSnapshotClass with CSI annotation; OPA/Gatekeeper policy requiring StatefulSets to carry a k10.kasten.io/backup label, enforcing backup governance at the admission layer.
- ArgoCD GitOps delivery with automated sync, self-heal for drift detection, and prune for removed resources; Application manifests managing Kasten infrastructure and application deployments from Git as source of truth.
- Pod Security Standards (restricted profile), default-deny NetworkPolicies, Gateway API routing, Kustomize-based team onboarding with namespace isolation, resource quotas, RBAC bindings, and LimitRanges. Architecture decisions documented via ADRs.

UpDog Monitor • FastAPI + Prometheus + Grafana + React • github.com/kyle-heller/UpDog-Monitor

- Full-stack uptime monitoring service: FastAPI backend with PostgreSQL (Alembic migrations), React/TypeScript frontend, and background worker performing health checks. SLO engine computing availability (99.5% target) and latency (p95 < 500ms) with error budget burn rate tracking over a rolling 30-day window.
- Prometheus instrumentation with custom histograms, counters, and gauges; Grafana dashboards provisioned via JSON. Alerting rules for SLO breaches, error budget burn rate, and endpoint downtime using histogram_quantile and rate queries.
- CI/CD via GitHub Actions: lint, test, build, push to GHCR, and Trivy container image scanning on CRITICAL/HIGH vulnerabilities. Kubernetes manifests with Kustomization for cluster deployment.

CERTIFICATIONS

Kubernetes & Cloud Native: Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) • Kubernetes and Cloud Native Security Associate (KCSA) • Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate (KCNA) • Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS, scheduled Apr 2026)

Azure & Cloud: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) • Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (AZ-400) • Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104)

Infrastructure & Other: HashiCorp Terraform Associate (004) • CCNA • VMCE • VMCA • VMware VCP-DCV

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder • M.S. Computer Science 2024 – 2026

The Ohio State University • B.S. 2016